

PHASE 5 SLATE (2025–2027): 10 FILMS + 2 DISNEY+ SERIES

The Secret Wars Saga, Part Two: "Time Runs Out"

Status:  SLATE COMPLETE (10 films + 2 series). All dossiers written.

FILMS (the main story)

#	Title	Release date	Owner	Dossier
1	Ant-Man and the Wasp: Rage of Ultron	Friday, February 14, 2025	Tyler Chapman (Elxa Bullock co-lead)	 complete
2	Captain Marvel: The Kree-Skrull War	Friday, May 2, 2025	Brie Larson	 complete
3	Guardians of the Galaxy: The Thanos Imperative	Friday, November 7, 2025	The Guardians ensemble (Chris Pratt leads)	 complete
4	Doom	Friday, May 1, 2026	Robert Downey Jr.	 complete
5	Ultimate Spider-Man	Friday, July 24, 2026	Shameik Moore	 complete
6	World War Hulk	Friday, November 6, 2026	Amond Baker	 complete
7	Captain America: Reborn	Friday, March 5, 2027	Tyrese Avery	 complete
8	Iron Man: Doomquest	Friday, May 7, 2027	Marc-Anthony Bullock (RDJ billed second)	 complete
9	Thor: The God Butcher	Friday, July 30, 2027	Esther Smilley	 complete
10	Avengers: Time Runs Out <i>(Phase 5 finale)</i>	Friday, December 17, 2027	The Avengers ensemble (Marc-Anthony Bullock & Tyrese Avery co-lead)	 complete

DISNEY+ SERIES (limit: 2 this phase)

#	Title	Premiere	Owner	Dossier
S1	The Punisher: Welcome Back, Frank (10 episodes)	Tue, March 3 → Tue, May 5, 2026 (weekly)	Jon Bernthal	 complete
S2	Moon Knight (8 episodes)	Tue, September 14 → Tue, November 2, 2027 (weekly)	Oscar Isaac	 complete

THE PHASE 5 ARC: "TIME RUNS OUT" (Hickman, 2014–15)

- **Cap remembers** the Illuminati's mind wipe (the end of Phase 4), and the heroes **split** again.
- **The Cabal**: **Namor** leads a group that **destroys other Earths without hesitation**. On 616 its members were **Thanos**, Black Swan, Maximus, Terrax, Proxima Midnight and Corvus Glaive.
- **The Beyonders** are **killing the gods of the multiverse**: the Celestials, the Living Tribunal.
- **Doom and the Molecule Man** go after the Beyonders.
- **The final shot of Phase 5**: everything goes **white**, then "**SECRET WARS**."

PHASE 5 FILM #1: ANT-MAN AND THE WASP: RAGE OF ULTRON

- **Release date**: Friday, February 14, 2025. Valentine's Day, for the franchise's married couple.
- **Comics**: *Avengers: Rage of Ultron* (2015 original graphic novel): **Ultron merges with Hank Pym**. Plus *Marvel Premiere* #47 (1979): **Scott Lang becomes Ant-Man**.

PHASE 5 FILM #2: CAPTAIN MARVEL: THE KREE-SKRULL WAR

- **Release date**: Friday, May 2, 2025. The first Friday in May.
- **Comics**: *The Kree-Skrull War* (*Avengers* #89–97, 1971), Roy Thomas, Neal Adams & John Buscema.

PHASE 5 FILM #3: GUARDIANS OF THE GALAXY: THE THANOS IMPERATIVE

- **Release date**: Friday, November 7, 2025. Marvel's fall slot.
- **Comics**: *The Thanos Imperative* (2010), Dan Abnett & Andy Lanning.

- **Real-world note:** James Gunn became co-CEO of **DC Studios** in November 2022 (real history), so **he can't direct**. The Guardians need a new director: **Joe Cornish**.

PHASE 5 SERIES #1: THE PUNISHER: WELCOME BACK, FRANK (Disney+)

- **Character:** Frank Castle / the Punisher. First appearance: *Amazing Spider-Man* #129 (1974).
- **Why:** he was set up in *Civil War* and *Daredevil: Born Again*. Garth Ennis's "Welcome Back, Frank" is the definitive Punisher story. It carries the **R-rated street-level label** (TV-MA).
- **Schedule:** 10 episodes, Tuesdays, March 3 to May 5, 2026, 50–58 minutes each. Disney+ moved to Tuesday premieres in 2025 (real history).

PHASE 5 FILM #4: DOOM

- **Character:** Victor von Doom, the saga's Big Bad.
- **Why:** before *Secret Wars*, the audience has to **understand Doom**: his mother, his pride, and why he believes **only he can save everything**. *Books of Doom* and *Triumph and Torment* tell that story on 616. The film ends with **Doom recruiting the Molecule Man**, which sets up *Secret Wars*.
- **Release date:** Friday, May 1, 2026. The first Friday in May, and the saga's villain gets **Marvel's biggest slot**. (*In the real world, Downey's Doom debuts in December 2026.*)

PHASE 5 FILM #5: ULTIMATE SPIDER-MAN

- **Character:** Miles Morales of Earth-1610. First appearance: *Ultimate Fallout* #4 (2011), Bendis & Pichelli.
- **Why:** the final Incursion of *Secret Wars* is Earth-616 against Earth-1610, the Ultimate Universe. The audience has to **see that world and care about it** before it dies. Miles is **the one hero on 616 who survives Secret Wars and comes over into our universe**.
- **Release date:** Friday, July 24, 2026. Mid-summer.
-  **Casting (locked):** Miles is **Shameik Moore** (31, per the Casting Rules; voiced Miles in the *Spider-Verse* films).

PHASE 5 FILM #6: WORLD WAR HULK

- **Character:** The Hulk (Amond Baker's third film).
- **Why:** *World War Hulk* is the payoff to *Planet Hulk* and the downfall of the Illuminati. When Cap exposes them, the Hulk comes back to judge them, and **the Illuminati are broken** just before the end.
- **Release date:** Friday, November 6, 2026. Marvel's fall slot.

PHASE 5 FILM #7: CAPTAIN AMERICA: REBORN

- **Character:** Steve Rogers, with **Bucky Barnes** taking up the shield (Tyrese Avery's fourth Cap film).
- **Why:** Ed Brubaker's *The Death of Captain America* and *Captain America: Reborn* follow straight on from his *Winter Soldier*, which the MCU has already adapted. **The man who exposed the Illuminati is shot on the courthouse steps, and the gun is Doom's technology**, which sends Steve **outside time** and gives Doom **the data he needs to survive the end of everything**.
- **Release date:** Friday, March 5, 2027, the week of the 20th anniversary of *Captain America* #25 (March 7, 2007).

PHASE 5 FILM #8: IRON MAN: DOOMQUEST

- **Character:** Tony Stark against **Doctor Doom**, one on one, for the first time.
- **Why:** *Doomquest* (*Iron Man* #149–150, 1981) is **the definitive Iron Man vs. Doom story**, and it runs on **Doom's time platform**, which the saga has been seeding since 2013. Tony comes home knowing that **Rabum Alal, the god-doom, is Doom** (Hickman's *New Avengers*, 2015).
- **Release date:** Friday, May 7, 2027. The first Friday in May, Iron Man's date since 2008.

PHASE 5 FILM #9: THOR: THE GOD BUTCHER

- **Character:** Thor, three times over (young, present, and old King Thor), against **Gorr** (Christian Bale).
- **Why:** Jason Aaron's *God of Thunder* is **the definitive modern Thor story**, and its subject, **someone murdering the gods**, is the exact shadow of *Time Runs Out*, where **the Beyonders kill the gods of the multiverse**. The post-credit scene is **the death of the Living Tribunal**.
- **Release date:** Friday, July 30, 2027. High summer.

PHASE 5 SERIES #2: MOON KNIGHT (Disney+)

- **Character:** Marc Spector / **Moon Knight**. First appearance: *Werewolf by Night* #32 (1975).
- **Why:** the franchise bible **held Moon Knight for the R-rated street-level label** so he'd never be watered down. **Oscar Isaac** is the only real actor to have played him. He's **the avatar of a god**, and **the gods are dying**, so Khonshu's fear brings the end of the world down to street level.
- **Schedule:** 8 episodes, Tuesdays, September 14 to November 2, 2027, 46–55 minutes each. **TV-MA**.

PHASE 5 FILM #10: AVENGERS: TIME RUNS OUT (the Phase 5 finale)

- **Characters:** the Avengers (led by Steve Rogers) vs. the Illuminati (led by Tony Stark), with the Cabal, the Beyonders and Doom.
- **Why: the phase is named after it.** Hickman's *Avengers* #35–44 and *New Avengers* #24–33 (2015), plus *Secret Wars* #1: Earth-616 and Earth-1610 collide, and everything dies.
- **Release date:** Friday, December 17, 2027. In-universe, the multiverse ends at 11:59 p.m. the night before.
- **The final shot of Phase 5:** everything goes white, then "*SECRET WARS.*"